

FPFK KERICHO TOWN CHURCH

Youth Ministry

YOUTH EXHORTATION

Rise and Build:

God's Call to Young People

to Be Industrious and Walk in the Power to Make Wealth

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A WORD TO THE YOUNG AND FIRE-FILLED

Young person, God is not asking you to wait until you are older to be useful. He is not asking you to sit and watch life pass by, hoping that one day opportunity will knock. He is calling you — right now, in the season of your youth — to rise, to roll up your sleeves, and to work with a purposeful and God-anointed diligence that will change your future and transform your community.

This exhortation carries two inseparable truths: **first, that hard work and industriousness are commanded by God**; and second, **that there is a divine power — not merely human effort** — that produces true, lasting wealth. You need both. Without diligence, the blessing has nothing to attach itself to. Without God's power, your effort will wear you out and leave you empty. But when the two come together, something extraordinary happens.

[PREACHER'S NOTE] *Open energetically. If preaching to youth, you might begin with a question: How many of you want to be successful? Now — how many of you are willing to work for it? And how many of you believe God is involved in that process? Set up the tension between effort and grace early.*

You may say to yourself, 'My power and the strength of my hands have produced this wealth for me.' But remember the Lord your God, for it is he who gives you the ability to produce wealth, and so confirms his covenant, which he swore to your ancestors, as it is today.

— **Deuteronomy 8:17–18**

Here is the paradox that young people must grasp: God gives the ability — and yet your hands must still work. The power is His. The labour is yours. He does not work while you sleep, and you cannot work while He withholds the blessing. It is a covenant partnership, and understanding this changes everything about how you approach your daily life, your studies, your trade, your business, and your calling.

I. GOD'S VIEW OF WORK

Before we speak about wealth, we must speak about work — because wealth that has not been built on the foundation of dignified, purposeful work is either stolen, borrowed, or temporary. Let us be clear about what God thinks of work:

A. Work Was God's Idea Before Sin Entered

Many young people have absorbed the lie — often from culture, sometimes even from a misreading of religion — that work is a punishment. They imagine that if Adam had not sinned, we would all be lounging in paradise doing nothing. But the Bible tells a different story:

The Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it.

— **Genesis 2:15**

Before the Fall. Before the curse. Before sin touched the earth — God placed man in the garden to work it and keep it. Work is not the consequence of sin; it is the image of God in us. God Himself worked for six days and rested on the seventh. When you work with skill, creativity, and diligence, you are reflecting the nature of your Creator. There is no shame in honest labour. There is glory in it.

B. The Book of Proverbs on Laziness

The wisdom literature of Scripture is direct — sometimes uncomfortably so — about laziness. The young person who is allergic to hard work is a young person building a future on sand:

Lazy hands make for poverty, but diligent hands bring wealth. He who gathers crops in summer is a prudent son, but he who sleeps during harvest is a disgraceful son.

— **Proverbs 10:4–5**

Notice the contrast: lazy hands and diligent hands. Both belong to someone. The question is which kind of hands you want to have. The harvest season is not forever — youth is a season, and the decisions you make now will determine the kind of future you will inhabit. The young person who wastes the season of strength and learning will spend the years of middle age trying to recover what was lost.

Challenge: *What is your harvest season right now? For some it is school. For some it is an apprenticeship. For some it is a business idea. Whatever the season, the question is: are you gathering, or are you sleeping?*

C. The Ant and the Sluggard

Go to the ant, you sluggard; consider its ways and be wise! It has no commander, no overseer or ruler, yet it stores its provisions in summer and gathers its food at harvest.

— **Proverbs 6:6–8**

God sends the lazy person — not to a boardroom, not to a university lecture — but to observe an ant. The ant does not wait to be told. It does not need supervision. It reads the season, understands the moment, and works with self-directed, purposeful energy. Young people, this is your call: to be self-motivated workers who do not need someone standing over them to produce excellence.

[PREACHER'S NOTE] *This is a great moment to be real and direct. Many youth are talented but passive. They are waiting for a sign, waiting for perfect conditions, waiting for someone to hand them an opportunity. The ant does not wait. Drive this home with energy.*

II. THE MARKS OF A TRULY INDUSTRIOUS YOUNG PERSON

Industriousness is not simply being busy. Many people are busy doing very little. True industriousness — the kind that God honours and rewards — has specific characteristics:

1. Excellence in the Small Things

Young people who want to be great tomorrow must be faithful in small things today. Jesus said it plainly: whoever is faithful in what is least will be faithful in much (Luke 16:10). Do not despise the small assignment, the small job, the limited income, the entry-level opportunity. That is where character is forged. That is where God watches to see if you can be trusted with more.

Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord, not for human masters, since you know that you will receive an inheritance from the Lord as a reward. It is the Lord Christ you are serving.

— **Colossians 3:23–24**

When you understand that your employer is ultimately the Lord, your attitude toward work changes entirely. You stop doing just enough to keep your job. You start doing everything as though Jesus Himself will evaluate the result — because He will.

2. Consistency Over Intensity

Many young people start with explosive energy and fade quickly. They have great launches and poor follow-through. True industriousness is not about occasional bursts of effort — it is about showing up consistently, day after day, doing the unglamorous work that accumulates into extraordinary results over time. The farmer does not harvest on the day he plants. He waters, tends, waits, and keeps working — and eventually the harvest comes.

Principle: *It is not the brilliant idea that creates wealth — it is the faithful, sustained execution of a good idea over a long period of time.*

3. Mastery of Your Craft

Do you see someone skilled in their work? They will serve before kings; they will not serve before officials of low rank.

— Proverbs 22:29

God rewards skill. Excellence in your area of calling is not pride — it is stewardship. Whether you are a student, a mechanic, a tailor, a teacher, a programmer, a farmer, or a pastor — become excellent at what God has placed in your hands. Excellence is not reserved for those with degrees. It belongs to anyone who commits to mastering their craft with discipline and devotion.

[PREACHER'S NOTE] *Ask the youth: What is your craft? What do you want to become known for? What skill are you currently developing? Give them a moment to reflect, or have them share with a neighbour.*

4. Discipline Over Desire

Every young person desires success. But desire without discipline is daydreaming. Joseph desired to be great — but between the dream and the palace lay years of slavery, false accusation, and imprisonment. What sustained him? Not a better set of circumstances but a disciplined, excellent spirit. Potiphar noticed it. The prison warden noticed it. Eventually Pharaoh noticed it. Your discipline will announce you before your mouth does.

Youth Challenge: *Write down the three habits you would need to build to become the person God is calling you to be. Now ask: Am I building those habits today, or just dreaming about the destination?*

III. THE POWER TO MAKE WEALTH — A COVENANT GIFT

Now we come to the most exciting — and most misunderstood — dimension of this exhortation. Deuteronomy 8:18 says that it is God who gives you the ability to produce wealth. The word translated 'ability' or 'power' in Hebrew is *koach* — it means strength, capacity,

vigour, the force or potency that enables production. This is not merely physical energy. It is a divinely-imparted endowment.

A. What Is the 'Power to Make Wealth'?

The power to make wealth is not a magic formula or a prosperity gospel shortcut. It is a multi-dimensional gift from God that includes:

- Mental capacity — the intelligence, creativity, and problem-solving ability to identify opportunity, innovate, and create value.
- Physical strength — the health and energy to work. Young people, do not take your health for granted. It is a wealth-creation asset. Honour God with your body.
- Relational capital — the ability to build trust, form networks, and work with others. No one creates wealth entirely alone. God opens doors through relationships.
- Discernment and wisdom — the ability to make sound decisions, to read seasons, to know when to invest, when to hold back, when to take a risk, and when to be patient.
- Spiritual anointing — a grace that causes your work to exceed what your natural ability alone could produce. This is the favour of God that the world cannot explain and cannot replicate.

The race is not to the swift or the battle to the strong, nor does food come to the wise or wealth to the brilliant or favour to the learned; but time and chance happen to them all.

— **Ecclesiastes 9:11**

Solomon understood that natural talent is insufficient on its own. The fastest runner does not always win. The strongest fighter does not always prevail. There is a divine factor — favour, timing, opportunity opened by the hand of God — that elevates the diligent person into extraordinary outcomes. This is not luck. It is covenant.

B. The Covenant Connection

Return to Deuteronomy 8:18: God gives you power to make wealth in order to confirm His covenant. This means that wealth creation — for the believer — is not merely personal ambition. It is a covenant statement. When God prospers a young believer who walks in obedience and diligence, He is declaring to the watching world: I am faithful to my covenant people.

This reframes wealth entirely. You are not building your empire. You are building a testimony. You are not just creating a financial future for yourself. You are becoming a demonstration of what God does for those who trust and obey Him. This means your success has a purpose beyond your comfort — it is meant to advance the kingdom of God.

[PREACHER'S NOTE] *Pause here and allow this to land. Many youth have been told that wanting to prosper financially is selfish or unspiritual. But the Bible connects covenant faithfulness with material blessing. The issue is not whether you prosper — it is who you are when you prosper, and what you do with it.*

C. Abraham: The Father of Covenant Wealth

Abram had become very wealthy in livestock and in silver and gold.

— **Genesis 13:2**

Abraham was not poor. Neither was Isaac (Genesis 26:12–14), who sowed in a time of famine and reaped a hundredfold — because the Lord blessed him. Neither was Jacob, whose covenant diligence turned Laban's flocks into his own (Genesis 30:43). The patriarchs were wealthy men. Their wealth was not separate from their covenant walk with God — it was inseparable from it.

Now you, young person, are an heir of Abraham through faith in Christ (Galatians 3:29). The same God who gave Abraham power to create wealth is your God. The same covenant that assured Isaac of harvest in a time of famine is your covenant. You are not building outside this covenant. You are building inside it — and that changes what is possible for you.

IV. THE ENEMIES OF INDUSTRIOUSNESS IN YOUTH

Let this exhortation also be honest about what threatens the industrious future God intends for you. There are real enemies — some internal, some external — that must be named and resisted:

1. Entitlement

One of the most dangerous attitudes in a young person is the belief that they deserve comfort, provision, and success without proportionate effort. Entitlement is the enemy of diligence. It produces young people who are quick to complain about what they do not have and slow to work for what they could obtain. The generation that expects to receive without labouring will be overtaken by the generation that works without complaining.

2. The Comparison Trap

Social media has given this generation a window into everyone's highlight reel — and none of their struggle. Young people see peers appearing to prosper overnight and become discouraged with the pace of their own progress. Comparison kills contentment and disrupts the focused diligence that builds lasting wealth. Run your race. God has assigned you a specific lane, a specific calling, and a specific timeline. Stay in your lane and run hard.

Each one should test their own actions. Then they can take pride in themselves alone, without comparing themselves to someone else, for each one should carry their own load.

— **Galatians 6:4–5**

3. Shortcuts and Get-Rich Schemes

Beware of any pathway to wealth that bypasses diligence, integrity, and time. Whether it is gambling, fraudulent business, exploitation, or the many schemes that promise overnight riches — these are traps designed to rob you of your future. Proverbs 13:11 is

unambiguous: 'Dishonest money dwindles away, but whoever gathers money little by little makes it grow.' Little by little. Brick by brick. Day by day. This is God's way.

Warning: *If someone is promising you wealth without work, wealth without time, or wealth without integrity — walk away. What they are selling is not prosperity; it is a snare.*

4. Spiritual Passivity

Some young believers have confused faith with passivity. They pray for harvest but have not planted. They believe in God's provision but will not take the first step of effort. Biblical faith is never passive — it is active trust expressed through obedient action. Noah built before the rain came. The disciples cast the net before the fish appeared (John 21:6). Faith and work are not opposites; faith energises work and gives it an eternal dimension.

V. PRACTICAL FOUNDATIONS FOR WEALTH-BUILDING

As a young person walking in both industriousness and covenant, here are practical foundations to build upon:

1. Invest in Your Mind

Proverbs 24:3–4 says: 'By wisdom a house is built, and through understanding it is established; through knowledge its rooms are filled with rare and beautiful treasures.' Your mind is your greatest wealth-creation asset. Read. Study. Learn skills. Pursue knowledge — both secular and spiritual. A young person who is a diligent learner is a young person who is accumulating invisible capital that will eventually produce visible wealth.

2. Work Before You Spend

The culture of consumption — buying things you cannot afford to impress people you do not know with money you have not earned — is a poverty cycle disguised as a lifestyle. Learn to delay gratification. Produce before you consume. Save before you spend. Invest before you enjoy. The ant stores in summer so that it can eat in winter — not the other way around.

3. Tithe and Give Firstfruits

Malachi 3:10 is both a command and a challenge: bring the whole tithe into the storehouse and test God in this. Honouring God financially with the firstfruits of your income is not merely a religious obligation — it is a spiritual principle that opens the windows of heaven. Young people who learn to honour God with the first of what they earn at the beginning of their productive years are positioning themselves for a lifetime of divine favour over their finances.

Honour the Lord with your wealth, with the firstfruits of all your crops; then your barns will be filled to overflowing, and your vats will brim over with new wine.

— Proverbs 3:9–10

4. Seek Godly Mentorship

Ecclesiastes 4:9 reminds us that two are better than one. Every young person who wants to build wisely needs older, experienced, godly voices in their life — people who have built well and who can speak wisdom into your decisions, warn you of pitfalls they have navigated, and open doors your inexperience cannot yet reach. Humble yourself to be mentored. Pride rejects the wisdom that experience offers.

5. Start Where You Are

Do not wait for the perfect opportunity, the right amount of capital, or the ideal circumstances. The servant who buried his talent while waiting for a better moment lost even what he had (Matthew 25:24–30). Start with what you have. Start where you are. The

mustard seed does not wait to become a tree before it begins to grow — it grows from the beginning, through every season.

Encouragement: *God is not looking for perfect conditions before He blesses you. He is looking for a young person who will be faithful with what they already have. Faithfulness is the magnet that attracts increase.*

VI. JOSEPH — THE PORTRAIT OF A DILIGENT, ANOINTED YOUNG PERSON

No biblical figure captures this exhortation more completely than Joseph, son of Jacob. He is the supreme portrait of what a young person who combines industriousness with divine power can become — and what they must endure to get there.

Joseph was seventeen when his story began to unfold. He was sold into slavery by his own brothers, stripped of every advantage, every connection, every comfort. He arrived in Egypt as a foreigner with nothing to his name. And yet — listen to this — God was with him:

The Lord was with Joseph so that he prospered, and he lived in the house of his Egyptian master. When his master saw that the Lord was with him and that the Lord gave him success in everything he did...

— **Genesis 39:2–3**

The Lord was with Joseph. That is the koach — the divine power to create wealth — at work in a slave's life. Not in a boardroom. Not in a place of privilege. In a foreign household, as a servant. And because Joseph was diligent, excellent, trustworthy, and morally courageous — the blessing had something to attach itself to, and it multiplied until Potiphar put everything he owned under Joseph's care.

Then came the pit a second time — false accusation, imprisonment, forgotten promises. But Joseph's character did not change with his circumstances. He served in prison with the same excellence he had shown in Potiphar's house. And when the moment came — God's appointed, sovereign moment — Joseph moved in one day from a prison cell to the second throne of Egypt.

The Joseph Principle: *Between your dream and your destiny lies a season of faithful, excellent, unseen work. Do not abandon the process. The God who gave you the dream is faithfully working in the waiting.*

Joseph's story ends with him declaring to the very brothers who sold him: 'You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good' (Genesis 50:20). This is the testimony of every young person who combines diligent industriousness with covenant trust in God — what the enemy means for destruction, God redirects for a purpose that exceeds anything you could have engineered on your own.

VII. RISE AND BUILD — A FINAL CHARGE

Young person, the world is not waiting for one more passive, entitled, distracted generation. The kingdom of God is not built by dreamers who never wake up. Your community, your nation, and the global church are waiting for a generation of young believers who combine the fire of the Holy Spirit with the grit of the diligent worker — young people who pray hard and work hard, who trust God deeply and plan wisely, who honour Him with their first and invest the rest with vision and purpose.

You have been given koach — the power to produce wealth. You have been placed in a covenant that has stood from Abraham to this day. You have been equipped with gifts, skills, and a calling that no one else on earth can fulfil in quite the same way. The question is

not whether God has given you enough to work with. He has. The question is: what will you do with what you have been given?

Nehemiah saw broken walls and said, 'Let us rise and build' (Nehemiah 2:18). This is your moment. The walls of your future are not yet built. The fields of your calling have not yet been harvested. The businesses of your generation have not yet been launched. The inventions, the songs, the schools, the churches, the farms, the enterprises — they are waiting for young hands that are willing to work and young hearts that are willing to trust.

I also told them about the gracious hand of my God on me and what the king had said to me. They replied, 'Let us start rebuilding.' So they began this good work.

— **Nehemiah 2:18**

Closing Charge: *Stand up, young person. Roll up your sleeves. Open your Bible. Close your mouth of complaint. Open your hands of work. Trust the God of covenant. He who gives you the power to make wealth is faithful — and He is watching, ready to confirm His covenant in your life as you rise and build.*

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